

Develop Swiftly...

Given that we'd done a FastTrack to Android Studio last month, it was only natural for us to lock in on Apple's Swift programming language before the hate mail starts pouring in accusing us of being biased towards Android. And what better time could it be to make a FastTrack for any of Apple's creations than around the time WWDC is held.

And there were quite a few exciting developments this year including iOS 10, Siri on Mac, Safari Picture in Picture, Easy switching between watch faces on the Apple Watch etc. But before you start developing for the entire gamut of Apple's devices you have to start small and that's where this FastTrack comes in.

Since a good portion of our FastTrack is written by freelancers we could literally see the lack of enthusiasm towards Apple's ecosystem. This made us investigate further and the answer wasn't that hard to find. Android Studio is available across all platforms, be it Windows, Linux or even Mac OS X. However, Xcode, the native IDE for making apps on Apple's devices is only available for Mac OS X. And therein lies the problem.

Apple's stringent quality control over its ecosystem and its insistence on avoiding fragmentation could be the reason why most people don't get into Swift. Which is why we show you how to develop for Apple's devices without having to go buy yourself a Macintosh for the sole reason of running Xcode. Thank heavens for Virtual Machines without which this FastTrack probably wouldn't have materialised.

Given what we experienced with the simple process of getting an IDE, we decided to make this process easier. Which is why we've covered the entire process of developing from the very moment you install Xcode, to writing your first app, to ensuring Apple's stringent guidelines are followed, and on towards getting your app published on the App Store. In a way, this has